

3.2 Component 2 – Biology: Environment, evolution and inheritance

Life on Earth is dependent on photosynthesis to fix carbon dioxide and produce the organic molecules used as the fuels for respiration and life processes.

Living organisms interact with one another and their environment in many different ways. Human behaviours may have beneficial or detrimental effects on natural populations and the environment. The chemicals in the environment are continually cycling through the natural world.

Life on Earth has evolved over time by natural selection, which accounts for biodiversity and how organisms are related. The characteristics of living things depend on both their environment and their genome.

Humans can now use genetic engineering to modify organisms.